

Cross-functional program and operations leader with experience spanning approximately \$30M in cumulative P&L responsibility, teams of up to 120, zero-to-one launches, vendor-led technical delivery, and measurable operating transformations. Brings an operator's accountability to strategy, planning, stakeholder alignment, governance, adoption, and outcome measurement.

PROGRAM STRATEGY, PROJECT PLANNING, CROSS-FUNCTIONAL LEADERSHIP, ROADMAPS & DEPENDENCIES, RAID & GOVERNANCE
VENDOR MANAGEMENT, BUDGET & P&L, CHANGE MANAGEMENT, PROCESS IMPROVEMENT, KPI DESIGN

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Mercor, AI Annotator and Quality Reviewer, Contract Feb 2026 to Present
AI QUALITY OPERATIONS

- Evaluate frontier-model outputs across finance, investment, strategy, business operations, engineering, and generalist work; advanced into reviewer responsibilities based on quality and judgment.

RYGNeco, Co-Founder and Program Lead 2025 to Present
ZERO-TO-ONE PRODUCT AND VENDOR PROGRAM

- Translated an enterprise e-waste pilot into four stakeholder portals spanning intake, testing, disposition, data-destruction records, pricing, and client reporting; directed an approximately \$11.5K vendor-built MVP.
- Processed 400+ devices, catalogued approximately 480, tested and verified 130, and recorded zero OSHA recordables during pilot operations.

EPIC Brands, General Manager, promoted from Assistant General Manager Jul 2025 to Feb 2026
OPERATING PORTFOLIO AND CONCEPT LAUNCH

- Led a \$10M portfolio with 70 hourly employees and six managers, contributing to 20% to 25% year-over-year growth; built an approximately \$800K events pipeline and reduced controllable costs by 10%.
- Opened Whiskey Yard through SOP development, 30-person hiring and training, and a 150-label whiskey program; bar revenue increased 18%.

Hard Rock Casino Cincinnati, Operations Manager, promoted to Assistant General Manager and Acting General Manager Jan 2024 to Jan 2025
OPERATIONAL TRANSFORMATION

- Held responsibility across three F&B outlets with approximately \$17M in combined P&L and 120 employees; recovered approximately \$14K per month in variance, maintained inventory variance below 1%, and reduced labor by 10%.
- Raised alcohol mix from 13% to 22% and upsell rate from 9% to 17% through analysis, training, certification, and reinforcement.

ITZCALI Tapas & Tequila, Director of Operations and Launch Consultant Sep 2022 to Jan 2024
HIGH-VOLUME LAUNCH PROGRAM

- Coordinated buildout, licensing, menus, vendors, pricing, POS, reservations, staffing, training, payroll, and launch readiness across a fixed opening window.
- Recruited and trained approximately 60 employees; generated \$165K in the first 14 days, served up to 600 covers nightly, reduced the menu from 45 items to 12, and cut cocktail production from approximately two minutes to 30 seconds.

MAK Trading, Trade with MAK, Founder and Program Lead Nov 2019 to Present
DIGITAL COMMUNITY AND GROWTH PROGRAM, MONETIZED 2022 TO 2023

- Built a global education community that reached approximately 2,000 members across channels and more than 1,200 cumulative paid subscribers over the program lifetime; a documented Stripe snapshot shows \$28.7K MRR and 321 active subscriptions.
- Led brand, acquisition, onboarding, content operations, a 48-page curriculum, member engagement, and a LaunchPass and Stripe to WordPress and MemberPress migration.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Napoli Italian Eatery, Opening Manager and Operations Lead, 2021 to 2022

MKEC, Mechanical Design Engineer, 2019 to 2020

Bella Luna Cafe, General Manager and Multi-Unit Lead, 2016 to 2019

EDUCATION AND CREDENTIALS

Wichita State University, Mechanical Engineering studies

University of Wales Trinity Saint David, Business & Management studies

ServSafe Manager, active through 2029

Languages, English, Arabic, Urdu, Hindi, Punjabi

Portfolio, samamak1.github.io